> Lest the discussion of my paper die completely, let me add some fuel to the fire with . . . criticisms of the 'Copenhagen interpretation.' . . . I do not think you can dismiss my viewpoint as simply a misunderstanding of Bohr's position. . . . I believe that basing quantum mechanics upon classical physics was a necessary provisional step, but that the time has come . . . to treat [quantum mechanics] in its own right as a fundamental theory without any dependence on classical physics, and to derive classical physics from it. . . .
>
> Let me mention a few more irritating features of the Copenhagen Interpretation. You talk of the massiveness of macro systems allowing one to neglect further quantum effects (in discussions of breaking the measuring chain), but never give any justification for this flatly asserted dogma. [And] there is nowhere to be found any consistent explanation for this 'irreversibility' of the measuring process. It is again certainly not implied by wave mechanics, nor classical mechanics either. Another independent postulate?

But Everett decided not to continue the academic fight. Before finishing his PhD, he accepted a job at the Weapons Systems Evaluation Group for the US Department of Defense, where he studied the effects of nuclear weapons. He would go on to do research on strategy, game theory, and optimization, and played a role in starting several new companies. It's unclear the extent to which Everett's conscious decision to not apply for professorial positions was motivated by criticism of his upstart new theory, or simply by impatience with academia in general.

He did, however, maintain an interest in quantum mechanics, even if he never published on it again. After Everett defended his PhD and was already working for the Pentagon, Wheeler persuaded him to visit Copenhagen for himself and talk to Bohr and others. The visit didn't go well; afterward Everett judged that it had been "doomed from the beginning."

Bryce DeWitt, an American physicist who had edited the journal where Everett's thesis appeared, wrote a letter to him complaining that the real world obviously didn't "branch," since we never experience such things. Everett replied with a reference to Copernicus's similarly daring idea that the Earth moves around the sun, rather than vice versa: "I can't resist asking: Do you feel the motion of the earth?" DeWitt had to admit that was a pretty good response. After mulling the matter over for a while, by 1970 DeWitt had become an enthusiastic Everettian. He put a great deal of effort into pushing the theory, which had languished in obscurity, toward greater public recognition. His strategies included an influential 1970 article in *Physics Today*, followed by a 1973 essay collection that included at last the long version of Everett's dissertation, as well as a number of commentaries.